WholeMind
RESILIENCE

Whistleblowing Policy

1. Purpose

This policy explains how anyone connected with WholeMind Resilience CIC can raise a serious concern about wrongdoing, and how we will protect them for doing so. It follows the Public Interest Disclosure Act 1998.

2. What You Can Raise

You can use this policy if you believe, in the public interest, that any of the following is happening, has happened, or is likely to happen:

- A crime
- A failure to meet a legal duty
- A miscarriage of justice
- A danger to someone's health and safety
- Damage to the environment
- Sexual harassment
- Someone covering up any of the above

This policy is not for personal grievances (raise these directly), safeguarding concerns (see the Safeguarding & Child Protection Policy) or service complaints (see the Complaints Policy).

3. How to Raise a Concern

- **Tell us first:** email the Executive Director, Annamarie Gammage, at info@wholemindresilience.co.uk.
- **Or go to an official regulator** for that area — for example, the Information Commissioner's Office for data protection, or the Health and Safety Executive for health and safety.
- **For a crime,** you can go to the police.
- **For a concern about WholeMind Resilience's purpose as a Community Interest Company** — for example, misuse of its assets — you can contact the CIC Regulator via gov.uk.

4. Your Legal Protection

The law protects workers who raise these concerns. You have the clearest legal protection if you raise your concern with us, or with an official regulator. The government lists these regulators on gov.uk under “Whistleblowing: list of prescribed people and bodies”.

The CIC Regulator is not on that list, so raising a concern only with them may not give you the same legal protection.

The law does not clearly cover self-employed freelancers or volunteers. Whatever your role, WholeMind Resilience will give you the same protection under this policy.

5. What Happens Next

- We will acknowledge your concern within 5 working days.
- We will take it seriously and look into it properly. This can take from a few days to several weeks.
- The Board will be told a concern has been raised at its next meeting, or sooner if there is a safety risk.
- We will keep your identity confidential wherever possible, and will not share it without your consent unless the law requires it.
- raising a concern you reasonably believe is true and in the public interest, even if it turns out to be mistaken.

- Knowingly false allegations are not protected.
- We may tell you the outcome where appropriate, as long as this does not break any confidentiality duty.

6. Review

This policy is reviewed annually.

7. Board Adoption

Adopted by the Board of WholeMind Resilience CIC